



**UNIQUE MIX** Barfly in Goa has an agave-only bar offering 15 signature cocktails and a list of tequilas, agaves, and mezcal

## NEW FAD

Prices of tequila and agave in India

| BRANDS               | PRICE   |
|----------------------|---------|
| Pistola Reposado*    | ₹2,985  |
| Pistola Añejo*       | ₹4,499  |
| Patrón Silver        | ₹5,180  |
| 818 Tequila Blanco   | ₹6,000  |
| Patrón Reposado      | ₹6,200  |
| 818 Tequila Reposado | ₹6,500  |
| Don Julio Blanco     | ₹8,060  |
| Don Julio Reposado   | ₹8,770  |
| Pistola Extra Añejo* | ₹9,999  |
| 818 Tequila Añejo    | ₹12,760 |
| Don Julio 1942       | ₹26,000 |
| 8 Reserve by 818     | ₹27,390 |

**NOTE** PRICES (PER BOTTLE) IN DELHI-NCR;

\*PRICES IN GOA **SOURCE** COMPANIES

818, there are various celebrity associations, which also adds to tequila's popularity among the youth. "This star-studded association that the category holds increases its allure among the general public as well, with many of those newly entering the legal drinking bracket (an expected 65 million consumers are to be of legal drinking age over the next five years), opting for tequila as their first choice of liquor," explains Achanta.

Kendall Jenner's 818 is being distributed in India exclusively by Berry Beverages, which also has the mandate for Clase Azul Tequila, a premium tequila with prices starting at ₹35,000 and going up to ₹5 lakh per bottle. Celebrities entering the tequila space, according to Sahir Berry, Founder of Berry Beverages, have helped elevate tequila to much higher standards than it was perceived before.

Back home, actor and film producer Rana Daggubati, along with musician/composer Anirudh Ravichander, has launched a tequila brand called Loca Loka in association with Hyderabad-based entrepreneur Harsha Vadlamudi (Managing Partner of microbrewery Ironhill India). They first launched the brand in the US, which is the world's largest tequila market, with plans to introduce it to India by the middle of next year. "Classically, alcohol in India has been in the whisky and rum space, but over the past decade there has been an increase in crafted spirit. Tequila has become a lifestyle extension more than anything else," says Daggubati.

So, is tequila the new gin for India? Rakshay Dhariwal, Founder and Managing Director of Maya Pistola Agavepura (Pistola), Asia's first premium aged 100% agave spirit—that is made in India—believes that the agave revolution in the country is just taking off. "Within the next five to six years, the consumer demand for newer agave variants will increase, especially due to the celebrity quotient that benefits the category. The next wave of cocktail culture is also driven by agave. As the gin phase saw multiple enthusiast clubs and on-ground events drawing crowds, the same can be said for agave," he says. Pistola, which was launched in 2022, is today available in the US, Thailand, and Singapore, besides India. Diageo's subsidiary, United Spirits, acquired a 15% stake in Pistola in April this year.

Whether it's a shot, a cocktail or a sipping drink, tequila and its cousins mezcal and agave are here to stay. **BT**

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